

Communications Board Report - April 2026

This is such a fun time in the communications world! There are so many exciting things happening across our district. It's a privilege to share the success with our community!

Collaborative - I'd like to give a special shout out to DCG's Culinary Educator Jozsef Grull. Jozsef's been a driving force in supporting the Tower Gardens at all seven DCG buildings. This project reached a milestone on May 7, when Chef Jozsef harvested the first batch of lettuce! The team from Chartwells will now prepare the lettuce to use in our DCG Cafeterias. We've covered the [Garden Tower project on social media](#) as we went along.

Passionate - The DCG School-to-Work program is such a passion project for so many people! Rylee Renz wrapped up her time as an intern in the communications department on May 7. Rylee set the bar for future school-to-work interns at DCG! Her work was showcased online, on ParentSquare and on social media. I'm excited to share her final [Senior Spotlight story](#), a showcase of the three school-to-work interns in the teaching profession. Rylee is off to Nebraska, where she will continue to do big things in her future endeavors!

Inclusive - I'm going to use this space to provide a quick update on ADA compliance at DCG. We've been working diligently to achieve 100% compliance on our district website. At last check, we are at 76%. There is a significant update on the timeline to reach 100% compliance. We now have until April of 2028 to get our standard set. Bigger communities also had their deadline extended until April of 2027. We provided an update to our cabinet team and admin assistants recently. We also plan to provide an update at our all-staff kickoff next year!

Supportive - Teacher Appreciation Week was a huge success at Dallas Center-Grimes! Thanks to our incredible community for showing the love to our teachers May 4-8. We also helped with a couple of videos that received great feedback from our followers, highlighted by [this one](#), which showcases students giving simple notes of gratitude to their teachers. Our final "staff celebration" of the 2025-26 school year was May 6, National School Nurse Day. We called our nursing staff the "Great Eight" for all of the ways they impact our students and staff!

Innovative - As we promised last month, DCG Decision Day was a huge success on May 1! The weather was decent (a little cold), but we had such a special afternoon honoring the DCG High School Class of 2026! Seniors heard from Superintendent Blum and Principal Blackmore. We took a group photo with the drone and lined up for a special Decision Day video. A special thanks to the DCG Booster Club and Grimes Hy-Vee for supporting the event. Thanks to Matthew Blackmore and Colin Lane for their partnership on this project. We can't wait to do it all again next year! Here is a link to the [coverage from Decision Day 2026](#).

Thanks for your continued support of the DCG Communications Department! Let me know if you have any questions!

AJ Ellingson

